

KEVIN GARSKE

Storyteller, Game Developer, Writer of Speculative Fiction

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SUMMARY

Organized, people-first contributor skilled in cross-team collaboration with game development organizations, looking to transition into the games industry as a Narrative Designer, Game Writer, or World Building/Lore writer. Skilled in storytelling for various media, with a terminal degree in Creative Writing and deep experience as an editor and shaper of prose. Adept at simplifying and communicating complex information for various audiences from 4+ years of teaching, training, and supervisory experience. Quick study who is curious about digging into the details of other stakeholders' wants and needs. Willing to relocate anywhere within California.

INDIE GAME DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

- **Narrative Game Jam 2023**: Narrative Designer for "Fallsbury Heresy"
- **Winter Visual Novel Jam 2024**: Narrative Designer for "Holiday Spirits"
- Indie Games Academy Level 1 and Level 2 Completion
- **Solo Dev 2D Platformer project**, "Anomaly: Project Pineheart"
- **Ludum Dare 58**: Narrative Designer for "Fragments of Wen Ruyi"

WORK EXPERIENCE

Manager, Recruiting and Staff Development

Compass Education Group Sep 2023 – Present

- Lead full-cycle recruiting and onboarding coordination for part-time staff across 6 offices, independently managing headcount, timelines, and documentation.
- Oversee all hiring documentation, offer letters, and pre-onboarding logistics, ensuring accuracy, timeliness, and confidentiality.
- Train roughly half of all incoming staff on company policy and procedures, and mentor new hires through their first 3 months on the job.
- Supervise interview teams and step in personally during high-volume periods to keep pipelines and schedules moving.

Partnership Development Manager (Volunteer)

Cave Bear Games Nov 2025 – Present

- Identify and manage relationships with prospective partners for a community of 5,000 indie developers and 150+ indie studios.
- Collaborate with the Executive Director and Events team to plan and deliver partner benefits through events, education, and mentorship programs.
- Launched and managed partnerships with organizations including ASGC and gamedevmap to support community members' career growth.

Narrative Designer, Worldbuilding Lead

Bright Harbor Studios Aug 2024 – Aug 2025

- Built out World Bible documentation for a large Action RPG in partnership with the art and level design teams.
- Wrote dialogue, barks, and story beats; pitched an original project in an internal pitch competition.
- Oversaw two narrative designers, coordinating direction and collaboration across the Worldbuilding team.

Recruiting Coordinator

Twitch Feb 2022 – Dec 2022

- Managed high-volume, global interview scheduling (~800 interviews, 300+ reschedules) across technical and non-technical roles.
- Partnered directly with team leadership to hit hiring targets while maintaining a strong candidate experience.
- Served as final editor on 50+ process documents for a company-wide Talent Acquisition Revamp project.

SKILLS

Creative: World-Building, Dialogue, Narrative Documentation, Prose writing

Tools: Unity, Twine, GitHub, Notion, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office Suite, Miro, Lucid,

EDUCATION

MFA, Fiction Writing — University of San Francisco (2023)

B.A., English Literature & Government (Dual Major) — Claremont McKenna College (2016)